literally bat all day, over after over, and, hour after hour, fielders like me simply had to run to fetch the ball from every corner of the garden.

On one such occasion, when I was around 10 years old, I remember suggesting to Gerrit that we should try bowling fast, low full tosses at Martin in the hope that, with his apparently impeccable technique, he would play the ball straight back to the bowler and succumb caught-and-bowled to the local one-hand-one-bounce rule. It was a decent idea, but it didn't work and Jarre continued to write the record books at Div Park.

In the years that followed, Martin proved a constant source of support and encouragement to me. He was an established member of the Titans squad when I arrived as a nervy teenager and, taking me under his wing, he would tell the coaches how well I was doing, giving me confidence when I needed it most.

At one practice, he handed me one of those trimmed-down slim bats and said he would throw the ball for me. To my horror, he then called the coaches over to watch me bat.

'Oh my goodness, look at this *laaitjie*,' he would exclaim out loud, making sure everybody could hear what he was saying, as I somehow managed to hit every delivery in the middle.

We both attended Warmbaths Primary School, and today the school's A field is named the Martin van Jaarsveld field and the B field is named after me. That's the way it should be. I owe Jarre more than he knows.

In our young minds, 20 Mentz Avenue was not simply a cricket venue. It was a cricket complex.

Aside from the main field, with its carefully rolled turf wicket, there was also the B field, an enclosed, cemented back yard outside the kitchen measuring no more than eight metres square. For my mother, this was where our clothes were hung out to dry. For us, it was a spinner's paradise, a wicket with as much turn and bounce as any in the Indian subcontinent. If ever there was a place to learn how to play spin, this was it.